

The Enlightenment (First Watch of the Night)

Bodhi Sutta (Ud 1.1)

Evam me sutam— ekam samayaṃ bhagavā uruvelāyaṃ viharati najjā nerañjarāya tīre bodhirukkhamūle paṭhamābhisambuddho. Tena kho pana samayena bhagavā sattāhaṃ ekapallaṅkena nisinno hoti vimuttisukhapaṭisaṃvedī. Atha kho bhagavā tassa sattāhassa accayena tamhā samādhimhā vuṭṭhahitvā rattiyā paṭhamam yāmaṃ paṭiccasamuppādam anulomaṃ sādhukaṃ manasākāsi:

Thus have I heard— At one time the Blessed One was staying in Uruvelā, on the bank of the river Nerañjarā, at the foot of the Bodhi tree, having just attained full enlightenment. At that time, the Blessed One sat in a single posture for seven days, experiencing the bliss of liberation (*sukha*). Then, after those seven days, the Blessed One emerged from that concentration (*samādhī*), and during the first watch of the night, he reflected closely on Dependent Origination (*paṭiccasamuppāda*) in forward order:

“Iti imasmiṃ sati idaṃ hoti, imassuppādā idaṃ uppajjati, yadidaṃ— avijjāpaccayā saṅkhārā, saṅkhārapaccayā viññāṇaṃ, viññāṇapaccayā nāmarūpaṃ, nāmarūpapaccayā saḷāyatanaṃ, saḷāyatanapaccayā phasso, phassapaccayā vedanā, vedanāpaccayā taṇhā, taṇhāpaccayā upādānaṃ, upādānapaccayā bhavo, bhavapaccayā jāti, jātipaccayā jarāmaraṇaṃ sokaparidevadukkhadomanassupāyāsā sambhavanti. Evametassa kevalassa dukkhakkhandhassa samudayo hotī”ti.

"When this exists, that exists; with the arising of this, that arises. That is to say: conditioned by ignorance (*avijjā*), mental reactions (*saṅkhāra*) arise; conditioned by mental reactions, consciousness arises; conditioned by consciousness, mind-and-matter (*nāmarūpa*) arise; conditioned by mind-and-matter, the six sense bases arise; conditioned by the six sense bases, contact arises; conditioned by contact, sensations (*vedanā*) arise; conditioned by sensations, craving (*taṇhā*) arises; conditioned by craving, clinging arises; conditioned by clinging, becoming arises; conditioned by becoming, birth arises; conditioned by birth, old age and death, sorrow, lamentation, pain, grief, and despair arise. Thus is the origination of this entire mass of suffering."

Atha kho bhagavā etamatthaṃ veditvā tāyaṃ velāyaṃ imam udānaṃ udānesi:

“Yadā have pātubhavanti dhammā, Ātāpino jhāyato brāhmaṇassa; Athassa kaṅkhā vapayanti sabbā, Yato pajānāti sahetudhamman”ti.

Paṭhamam.

Then, the Blessed One, understanding the significance of this, uttered this inspired utterance in that moment: "When truths become clear indeed to the ardent (*ātāpī*), meditating Brahmin, then all his doubts vanish, since he understands phenomena with their causes." (First)

Glossary

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
paṭiccasamuppāda	paṭiccasamuppāda	dependent origination	Bodhi Sutta	The law of cause and effect showing how suffering arises and ceases, observed and dismantled through self-observation.
saṅkhāra	saṅkhāra	mental reaction; mental conditioning	Bodhi Sutta	The habit of the mind to react to physical sensations with craving or aversion, conditioning subsequent cycles of existence.
nāmarūpa	nāmarūpa	mind-and-matter	Bodhi Sutta	Translated as "mind-and-matter" or "mind-and-body" rather than literal "name-and-form," highlighting their reciprocal, experiential interaction.

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
vedanā	vedanā	bodily sensation	Bodhi Sutta	Understood strictly as physical/bodily sensations, which serve as the critical junction point where reactive habit loops are triggered.
taṇhā	taṇhā	craving	Bodhi Sutta	The deep mental thirst/reaction that arises in response to sensations, leading directly to clinging and suffering.
ātāpī	ātāpī	ardent; persistent	Bodhi Sutta	Reflects the persistent, patient effort required in Vipassana meditation (e.g. "patiently and persistently").

Translator Notes

1. **Mind-and-Matter vs. Name-and-Form:** Translated *nāmarūpa* as "mind-and-matter" to align with Goenkaji's experiential framing of the physical and mental processes, avoiding the dry, literal translation of "name-and-form."
2. **Sensations for *Vedanā*:** In accordance with the Goenka anchor guidelines, *vedanā* is rendered strictly as "sensations" (not "feelings") to emphasize the physical, somatic basis of reactivity in the dependent origination chain.

3. **Brahmin Register:** Translated *brāhmaṇa* as "Brahmin" but with the context of a purified, meditating seeker, in line with the tradition's universal (non-sectarian) redefinition of the term.